COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TUBE, BIOLOGICAL CULTURE SAMPLING, Pledget Style, with Transport Media, Plastic

This Commercial Item Description covers a sterile, pledget style, biological culture sampling tube, suitable for collecting and holding biological cultures moist and viable for 72 hours.

Salient characteristics:

Shall be an assembled sterile biological culture sampling tube suitable for collecting and holding biological cultures, such as pseudomonas aeruginosa ATCC No. 15442 and Group a Streptococcus ATCC No. 7958, moist and viable for 72 hours.

As a minimum shall consist of a plastic tube, snug-fitting closure cap, applicator swab, absorbent fabric plug (pledget), and transport media. Shall be supplied sealed in a peel-open type envelope suitable for maintaining sterility until manually opened. The envelope shall not be resealable after opening.

The method and efficacy of sterilization of the biological tube and inside surfaces of the envelope shall be acceptable to the Food and Drug Administration (FDA).

The tube shall be fabricated of transparent or translucent semi-rigid plastic. The distal end shall be closed to preclude leakage of transport media. The opposite end shall be open, and shall be supplied with a snug-fitting and readily removable closure cap.

The applicator stick shall be wood or plastic and cylindrical in shape with nominal dimensions (inches) of 3/32 diameter x 5 long. The distal end of the stick shall be covered with a swab tip made of cotton, rayon, or polyester. A suitable adhesive shall be used to secure the swab tip to the stick.

The transport media shall be Modified Stuarts media or Amies media without charcoal.

The Modified Stuarts transport media shall be supplied in a crushable glass ampule. The ampule shall be located in the distal portion of the tube below the absorbent fabric plug (pledget) that shall separate the ampule from the applicator swab.

The Amies swab transport media shall be contained in a sealed chamber located at the distal end of the tube, with the absorbent fabric plug (pledget) positioned to separate the sealed chamber from the applicator swab.

The method of moistening the swab tip shall be included in the manufacturer's instructions.

The volume of transport media shall be sufficient to cover and moisten all surfaces of the swab tip, after passing through the absorbent fabric plug (pledget), and keep any collected live cultures located on any sector (surface) of the swab tip viable for 72 hours.

When the swab tip is moistened, by following manufacturer's instructions, the released transport media shall completely cover and completely moisten the swab tip without exhibiting the following (see Quality Assurance Provisions):

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1. A coating or splattering of the transport media on the upper portion of the swab stick (i.e., upper half of the exposed length).

2. A coating or splattering of the transport media on the upper half of the inside surfaces of the tube.

3. A coating or splattering of the transport media on the outside of the tube.

Workmanship. The biological culture sampling tube shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impairs its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing one hundred individually packaged tubes, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics. Biological culture tubes shall be tested to assure that the transport media is released in accordance with manufacturer's instructions, and is controlled so that the swab tip is properly moistened without exhibiting the deficiencies listed in the salient characteristics. The sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an inspection level of S-3 and an acceptance of zero. The unit of product for testing shall be the individual biological culture tube, with no less than two tubes selected from a unit package.

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Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U. S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6640-01-161-1859

Ordering data (intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

VA-OSS

PGC 51877

Project No. 6640-1295

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-50978	Tube, Biological Culture Sampling

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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